



GSFA Online

Updated up to the 48th Session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (2025)

FOOD ADDITIVE GROUP DETAILS

POLYSORBATES

The provisions that follow are defined at the additive group level, and thus apply to the *total* content of the additives participating in this group. Additives that make up this group are provided for reference only.

Participating Additive(s)

INS No. Additive Name

-  432 Polyoxyethylene (20) sorbitan monolaurate
-  433 Polyoxyethylene (20) sorbitan monooleate
-  434 Polyoxyethylene (20) sorbitan monopalmitate
-  435 Polyoxyethylene (20) sorbitan monostearate
-  436 Polyoxyethylene (20) sorbitan tristearate

CSV (Tables)

GSFA Provisions for POLYSORBATES

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 14.2.7	Aromatized alcoholic beverages (e.g. beer, wine and spirituous cooler-type beverages, low alcoholic refreshers)	120 mg/kg	
 06.6	Batters (e.g. for breading or batters for fish or poultry)	5,000 mg/kg	 Note 2
 01.3.2	Beverage whiteners	4,000 mg/kg	 Note XS252  Note XS250
 07.1.4	Bread-type products, including bread stuffing and bread crumbs	3,000 mg/kg	 Note 11
 07.1.1	Breads and rolls	3,000 mg/kg	
 06.5	Cereal and starch based desserts (e.g. rice pudding, tapioca pudding)	3,000 mg/kg	
 05.3	Chewing gum	5,000 mg/kg	
 12.6.4	Clear sauces (e.g. fish sauce)	5,000 mg/kg	 Note XS302
 01.4.3	Clotted cream (plain)	1,000 mg/kg	
 05.1.4	Cocoa and chocolate products	5,000 mg/kg	 Note 101
 05.1.2	Cocoa mixes (syrops)	500 mg/kg	
 05.1.3	Cocoa-based spreads, including fillings	1,000 mg/kg	 Note XS86
 05.2	Confectionery including hard and soft candy, nougats, etc. other than food categories 05.1, 05.3 and 05.4	1,000 mg/kg	 Note XS309R
 07.1.2	Crackers, excluding sweet crackers	5,000 mg/kg	 Note 11
 01.4.4	Cream analogues	5,000 mg/kg	
 01.7	Dairy-based desserts (e.g. pudding, fruit or flavoured yoghurt)	3,000 mg/kg	 Note 629
 05.4	Decorations (e.g. for fine bakery wares), toppings (non-fruit) and sweet sauces	3,000 mg/kg	
 13.3	Dietetic foods intended for special medical purposes (excluding products of food category 13.1)	1,000 mg/kg	 Note 566
 13.4	Dietetic formulae for slimming purposes and weight reduction	1,000 mg/kg	
 14.2.6	Distilled spirituous beverages containing more than 15% alcohol	120 mg/kg	

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 06.4.2	Dried pastas and noodles and like products	5,000 mg/kg	
 08.4	Edible casings (e.g. sausage casings)	1,500 mg/kg	
 03.0	Edible ices, including sherbet and sorbet	1,000 mg/kg	
 10.4	Egg-based desserts (e.g. custard)	3,000 mg/kg	
 12.6.1	Emulsified sauces and dips (e.g. mayonnaise, salad dressing, onion dip)	3,000 mg/kg	
 02.3	Fat emulsions mainly of type oil-in-water, including mixed and/or flavoured products based on fat emulsions	5,000 mg/kg	 Note 102
 02.2.2	Fat spreads, dairy fat spreads and blended spreads	10,000 mg/kg	 Note 360  Note 557
 02.4	Fat-based desserts excluding dairy-based dessert products of food category 01.7	3,000 mg/kg	 Note 102
 07.2	Fine bakery wares (sweet, salty, savoury) and mixes	3,000 mg/kg	
 01.1.4	Flavoured fluid milk drinks	3,000 mg/kg	 Note 629
 13.6	Food supplements	25,000 mg/kg	
 04.1.2.11	Fruit fillings for pastries	3,000 mg/kg	
 04.1.2.8	Fruit preparations, including pulp, purees, fruit toppings and coconut milk	1,000 mg/kg	 Note XS314R  Note 154
 04.1.2.9	Fruit-based desserts, including fruit-flavoured water-based desserts	3,000 mg/kg	
 12.2.1	Herbs and spices	2,000 mg/kg	 Note XS353  Note XS352  Note XS326  Note XS347  Note XS342  Note XS343  Note XS328  Note XS351  Note XS344  Note XS327  Note XS345
 05.1.5	Imitation chocolate, chocolate substitute products	5,000 mg/kg	
 02.1.3	Lard, tallow, fish oil, and other animal fats	5,000 mg/kg	 Note XS19  Note 102  Note XS211
 01.5.2	Milk and cream powder analogues	4,000 mg/kg	 Note XS251
 07.1.6	Mixes for bread and ordinary bakery wares	3,000 mg/kg	 Note 11
 12.6.3	Mixes for sauces and gravies	5,000 mg/kg	 Note 127
 12.6.2	Non-emulsified sauces (e.g. ketchup, cheese sauce, cream sauce, brown gravy)	5,000 mg/kg	 Note 580
 07.1.3	Other ordinary bakery products (e.g. bagels, pita, English muffins)	3,000 mg/kg	 Note 11
 01.4.1	Pasteurized cream (plain)	1,000 mg/kg	 Note 626
 06.4.3	Pre-cooked pastas and noodles and like products	5,000 mg/kg	 Note 153
 08.3	Processed comminuted meat, poultry, and game products	5,000 mg/kg	 Note XS89  Note XS98  Note XS88
 08.2	Processed meat, poultry, and game products in whole pieces or cuts	5,000 mg/kg	 Note XS96  Note XS97
 12.7	Salads (e.g. macaroni salad, potato salad) and sandwich spreads excluding cocoa- and nut-based spreads of food categories 04.2.2.5 and 05.1.3	2,000 mg/kg	
 12.1.1	Salt	10 mg/kg	
 12.2.2	Seasonings and condiments	5,000 mg/kg	
 12.5	Soups and broths	1,000 mg/kg	
 06.8.1	Soybean-based beverages	2,000 mg/kg	 Note 645

Number	Food Category	Max Level	Notes
 07.1.5	Steamed breads and buns	3,000 mg/kg	 Note 11
 01.4.2	Sterilized and UHT creams, whipping and whipped creams, and reduced fat creams (plain)	1,000 mg/kg	
 01.6.1	Unripened cheese	80 mg/kg	 Note 38  Note XS221  Note XS275  Note XS262  Note XS273
 04.2.2.6	Vegetable (including mushrooms and fungi, roots and tubers, pulses and legumes, and aloe vera), seaweed, and nut and seed pulps and preparations (e.g. vegetable desserts and sauces, candied vegetables) other than food category 04.2.2.5	3,000 mg/kg	 Note XS57  Note XS308R  Note XS259R
 02.1.2	Vegetable oils and fats	5,000 mg/kg	 Note XS19  Note XS210  Note XS325R  Note 102  Note XS33
 14.1.4	Water-based flavoured drinks, including "sport," "energy," or "electrolyte" drinks and particulated drinks	500 mg/kg	 Note 127

Note: Unless otherwise specified, food additive provisions apply to the food category indicated (e.g. Dairy), as well as to all subcategories of that category (e.g. Cheese, Ripened Cheese, etc.).

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